

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1064

By Russell

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Thomas Cory Myers Gunnels.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Thomas Cory Myers Gunnels on March 24, 2021; and

WHEREAS, Cory Gunnels was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on May 12, 1982, Cory Gunnels was the son of our former colleague Representative Doug Gunnels and Vicki Gunnels; and

WHEREAS, as a youngster, Cory and his brother, Brett, spent much of their childhood years running in the halls of the State Capitol complex, making many friends, including legendary Chief Sergeant at Arms of the House of Representatives Victor Thompson, who dubbed them "my boys"; and

WHEREAS, after graduating from Greenback High School in 2000, Cory Gunnels earned a Bachelor of Science degree in Business Administration from the University of Tennessee in 2005; and

WHEREAS, on August 7, 2010, he was joined in holy matrimony with the love of his life, Ashton Radcliff, and their joyous union was blessed on January 13, 2015, with one son, Cabe Harley Gunnels, who was the apple of his father's eye; and

WHEREAS, Cory Gunnels had a passion for his family's farm and spent much of his time there. An avid fan of the Tennessee Volunteers, he also loved hunting, fishing, gardening, and traveling, especially out west to snowboard with his friends; and

WHEREAS, a man of deep and abiding faith, Mr. Gunnels was a lifelong member of Pine Grove Presbyterian Church, where friends and colleagues contributed \$18,500 for the construction of a new playground in his honor; and

WHEREAS, a devoted son, brother, father, and husband, Cory Gunnels leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, throughout his courageous battle with cancer, Cory Gunnels showed us all what a real fighter looks like; he truly fought the good fight, finished the race, and kept the faith; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the life of this exceptional gentleman and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Thomas Cory Myers Gunnels, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Gunnels.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.